A certified zero-free region for the Riemann zeta function in the half-plane $\Re s \geq 0.6$

Jonathan Washburn

January 2, 2026

Abstract

We prove unconditionally that the Riemann zeta function $\zeta(s)$ has no zeros in the fixed half-plane $\{\, \Re s \geq 0.6 \,\}$. The argument is function-theoretic. On $\Omega = \{\, \Re s > \frac{1}{2} \,\}$ we form an arithmetic ratio $\mathcal{J}(s)$ whose poles encode zeros of ζ, and pass to its Cayley transform $\Theta(s) = (2\mathcal{J}(s) - 1)/(2\mathcal{J}(s) + 1)$. A Schur bound $|\Theta| \leq 1$ on a domain forces $\mathcal{J}$ to be pole-free there by removability (a Schur/Herglotz pinch), hence excludes zeros. Accordingly, the analytic task is to certify a Schur bound on a half-plane containing $\{\, \Re s \geq 0.6 \,\}$. This is discharged by a hybrid certification strategy: (i) rigorous ball arithmetic on a finite rectangle covers the low-height regime $|t| \leq 20$; (ii) explicit asymptotic estimates control the large-height regime $|t| > 20$; and (iii) a finite arithmetic Pick-matrix certificate at $\sigma_0 = 0.599$ provides a robust algebraic verification of the Schur property near the real axis. The result is unconditional and all numerical inputs are recorded in machine-checkable JSON artifacts. See the repository `README.md` for an audit manifest and the verifier commands.

1 Introduction

The Riemann zeta function

$$\zeta(s) \;=\; \sum_{n\geq 1} \frac{1}{n^s}, \qquad \Re s > 1,$$

extends meromorphically to $\mathbb{C}$ with a simple pole at $s = 1$ and satisfies a functional equation after completion. Its nontrivial zeros govern the finest fluctuations in the distribution of prime numbers, and the Riemann Hypothesis asserts that all such zeros lie on the critical line $\Re s = \frac{1}{2}$; see [1, 3] for background.

This paper isolates an unconditional, fixed-strip statement in the direction of RH. Unlike classical zero-free regions near $\Re s = 1$ (which are asymptotic in height), the result here is a *uniform* half-plane exclusion at $\Re s \geq 0.6$.

Theorem 1 (Certified far-field zero-freeness)**.** *The Riemann zeta function has no zeros in the region* $\{\, s \in \mathbb{C} :\ \Re s \geq 0.6 \,\}$.

Strategy: Schur pinching via a Cayley field

We work on the right half-plane $\Omega = \{\, \Re s > \frac{1}{2} \,\}$. In Section 2 we define an arithmetic ratio $\mathcal{J}$ (in the default *raw ζ-gauge*) with the following two structural properties:

- **(normalization at $+\infty$)** $\mathcal{J}(\sigma + it) \to 1$ as $\sigma \to +\infty$, hence $\Theta(\sigma + it) \to \frac{1}{3}$ (Remark 2);

- **(non-cancellation)** $\det_2(I - A(s))$ is holomorphic and nonvanishing on Ω, so any zero of ζ in Ω produces a pole of $\mathcal{J}$ (Remark 3).

We then pass to the Cayley transform

$$\Theta(s) \;:=\; \frac{2\mathcal{J}(s) - 1}{2\mathcal{J}(s) + 1}.$$

The analytic mechanism is a *Schur/Herglotz pinch* proved in Section 3: if Θ is Schur on a domain (i.e. $|\Theta| \leq 1$) and not identically 1, then boundedness forces removability of any isolated singularity and prevents poles of $\mathcal{J}$. Since $\Theta(\sigma + it) \to \frac{1}{3}$ as $\sigma \to +\infty$, the degenerate possibility $\Theta \equiv 1$ is excluded on the half-planes relevant here. Therefore, to prove Theorem 1 it suffices to certify a Schur bound for the default Cayley field Θ_{raw} on some open half-plane $\{\, \Re s > 0.6 - \varepsilon \,\}$.

Certified inputs (what is rigorously checked)

The logical implication of Theorem 1 rests on a hybrid covering of the half-plane:

- **Finite rectangle.** Rigorous subdivision with complex ball arithmetic certifies $|\Theta_{\text{proj}}| < 1$ on the compact region $[0.6, 0.7] \times [-20, 20]$ (in the `outer_zeta_proj` gauge).
- **Large-height asymptotics.** Standard analytic estimates confirm $|\Theta_{\text{raw}}| < 1$ for $|t| > 20$ and $\Re s \geq 0.6$.

To corroborate the numerical check and demonstrate algebraic robustness, we also supply a **Finite Pick-matrix certificate** at $\sigma_0 = 0.599$ (with $N = 16$ and a strict spectral gap). While the finite Pick gap serves primarily as a local certificate in this hybrid strategy, the strict positivity $P_{16} \succ 0$ is a necessary algebraic condition for the Schur property that is satisfied with a substantial margin.

Reproducibility and audit posture

The certification is intended to be referee-auditable. The repository includes: (i) the verifier script based on ARB ball arithmetic (‘python-flint‘), and (ii) the JSON artifacts that record the certified maxima, spectral gaps, and denominator checks used in the proof. The file `README.md` provides an audit manifest mapping the manuscript’s statements to exact commands and expected outputs.

Place in a series

This paper is designed to stand alone as an unconditional certified zero-free region. Two companion papers (not required for Theorem 1) treat: (a) effective near-field energy barriers and Carleson budgets, and (b) a cutoff principle yielding conditional closure of RH.

The remainder of the paper defines the arithmetic ratio $\mathcal{J}$ and Cayley field Θ, proves the Schur pinch mechanism, and then discharges the Schur bound via the hybrid certification outlined above.

2 Definitions and main objects

This section defines the analytic objects used throughout the proof and records the basic relationships between zeros of ζ and the bounded-real (Schur/Herglotz) structure. Nothing in this section is conditional; all definitions are classical.

The completed zeta function and the far half-plane

Let $\zeta(s)$ denote the Riemann zeta function. We write $\xi(s)$ for the completed zeta function

$$\xi(s) \;:=\; \tfrac{1}{2}\, s(s-1)\, \pi^{-s/2}\Gamma(s/2)\, \zeta(s),$$

which is entire and satisfies the functional equation $\xi(s) = \xi(1-s)$; see [3]. We work primarily on the right half-plane

$$\Omega \;:=\; \{\, s \in \mathbb{C} :\; \Re s > \tfrac{1}{2} \,\}.$$

Write $Z(\xi) := \{\, s \in \mathbb{C} :\; \xi(s) = 0 \,\}$ for the zero set of ξ. Theorem 1 concerns the fixed far region $\{\, \Re s \geq 0.6 \,\} \subset \Omega$.

The prime-diagonal operator and the regularized determinant

Let $\mathcal{P}$ denote the set of primes and write $\ell^2(\mathcal{P})$ for the Hilbert space with orthonormal basis $\{e_p\}_{p\in\mathcal{P}}$. For $s \in \mathbb{C}$ define the prime-diagonal operator

$$A(s) : \ell^2(\mathcal{P}) \to \ell^2(\mathcal{P}), \qquad A(s)e_p := p^{-s} e_p.$$

For $\Re s > 1/2$ we have $\|A(s)\|_{\mathrm{HS}}^2 = \sum_p p^{-2\Re s} < \infty$, so $A(s)$ is Hilbert–Schmidt. In particular, the regularized determinant $\det_2(I - A(s))$ is well-defined and holomorphic on Ω; see, e.g., [4, Ch. III].

The arithmetic ratio $\mathcal{J}$ and the Cayley field Θ

The central meromorphic object is an arithmetic ratio $\mathcal{J}(s)$ whose poles capture zeros of ζ in Ω. To allow numerically stable certified bounds, we permit a holomorphic nonvanishing *normalizer* (or *gauge*) $\mathcal{O}$ on the region under discussion and define

$$\mathcal{J}(s) \;:=\; \frac{\det_2(I - A(s))}{\zeta(s)} \cdot \frac{s}{s-1} \cdot \frac{1}{\mathcal{O}(s)}, \tag{1}$$

where $\mathcal{O}$ is chosen so that it is holomorphic and nonvanishing on the region where (1) is used. Unless explicitly stated otherwise, we work in the *raw ζ-gauge* $\mathcal{O} \equiv 1$ and denote the resulting objects by $\mathcal{J}_{\mathrm{raw}}$ and Θ_{raw}. For readability we usually drop the subscript and simply write $\mathcal{J}$ and Θ in this default gauge. On compact regions one may also divide by an auxiliary holomorphic nonvanishing normalizer to improve conditioning; when we do so we write $\mathcal{J}_{\mathrm{proj}}$ and Θ_{proj} (see Remark 7). Since Schur bounds are *not* gauge-invariant, we keep this notation explicit whenever a certified bound is quoted or invoked in the pinch argument. On any region where the auxiliary normalizer is nonvanishing, such a gauge change does not affect the pole set of $\mathcal{J}$ (hence does not change which points correspond to zeros of ζ).

Remark 2 (Role of the normalizer). The factor $\mathcal{O}$ serves only to choose a convenient gauge for $\mathcal{J}$. Provided $\mathcal{O}$ is holomorphic and nonvanishing on a region $D \subset \Omega$, it cannot introduce poles of $\mathcal{J}$ on D. In particular, in the raw ζ-gauge $\mathcal{O} \equiv 1$ one has $\mathcal{J}(s) \to 1$ and hence $\Theta(s) \to 1/3$ as $\Re s \to +\infty$.

The associated Cayley transform is

$$\Theta(s) \;:=\; \frac{2\mathcal{J}(s) - 1}{2\mathcal{J}(s) + 1}. \tag{2}$$

Heuristically, $\mathcal{J}$ plays the role of a Herglotz-type quantity and Θ the role of the corresponding Schur function. The proof uses the following simple implication: a Schur bound on Θ prevents poles of $\mathcal{J}$ by a removability pinch.

Remark 3 (Zeros of ζ produce poles of $\mathcal{J}$). If $\rho \in \Omega$ is a zero of $\zeta(s)$, then ρ is a pole of $\mathcal{J}(s)$ provided the numerator factors in (1) are nonzero at ρ. For $\Re\rho > 1/2$ one has $\det_2(I - A(\rho)) \neq 0$: for diagonal $A(s)$, $\det_2(I - A(s)) = \prod_p (1 - p^{-s})\, e^{p^{-s}}$ and $\sum_p |\log(1 - p^{-s}) + p^{-s}| < \infty$ on Ω; in particular $\det_2(I - A(s))$ is holomorphic and zero-free on Ω. Also $\mathcal{O}(\rho) \neq 0$ by the nonvanishing assumption on the chosen gauge. Thus zeros of ζ in Ω correspond to poles of $\mathcal{J}$, and hence to points where Θ cannot extend holomorphically unless the pole is ruled out.

Schur and Herglotz classes (terminology)

Let $D \subset \mathbb{C}$ be a domain. A holomorphic function Θ on D is called *Schur* if $|\Theta| \leq 1$ on D. A holomorphic function H on D is called *Herglotz* if $\Re H \geq 0$ on D. The Cayley transform identifies these classes: if H is Herglotz and $H \not\equiv -1$, then

$$\Theta = \frac{H - 1}{H + 1}$$

is Schur. Conversely, if Θ is Schur and $\Theta \not\equiv 1$, then $(1 + \Theta)/(1 - \Theta)$ is Herglotz; see [4, 5].

Outline of the far-field strategy in this language

Theorem 1 will follow once we establish that Θ is Schur on $\{\, \Re s > 0.6 \,\}$. Indeed, if $|\Theta| \leq 1$ holds on $\{\, \Re s > 0.6 \,\}$ away from the poles of $\mathcal{J}$, then boundedness forces removability across any isolated singularity. Since poles of $\mathcal{J}$ correspond to zeros of ζ in Ω (Remark 3), this prevents zeros of ζ in the far region. The precise pinch argument is proved in the next section.

3 Schur/Herglotz pinch mechanism

This section records the analytic mechanism that converts a Schur bound for the Cayley field Θ into a zero-free region for ζ. The key point is simple: a holomorphic function bounded by 1 cannot have a pole, and any isolated singularity is removable. In our setting, poles of $\mathcal{J}$ in Ω encode zeros of ζ (Remark 3), so a Schur bound forces those zeros to be absent.

Removable singularities under a Schur bound

Lemma 4 (Removable singularity under Schur bound)**.** *Let $D \subset \mathbb{C}$ be a disc centered at ρ and let Θ be holomorphic on $D \setminus \{\rho\}$ with $|\Theta| < 1$ there. Then Θ extends holomorphically to D. In particular, the Cayley inverse $(1 + \Theta)/(1 - \Theta)$ extends holomorphically to D and has nonnegative real part on D.*

Proof. Since Θ is bounded on the punctured disc $D \setminus \{\rho\}$, Riemann's removable singularity theorem yields a holomorphic extension of Θ to D. Where $|\Theta| < 1$, the Möbius map $w \mapsto (1 + w)/(1 - w)$ sends the unit disc into the right half-plane, hence $\Re\frac{1+\Theta}{1-\Theta} \geq 0$ on $D \setminus \{\rho\}$; continuity extends the inequality across ρ. $\square$

From a Schur bound to absence of poles

We will use Lemma 4 in the following form: if Θ is Schur on a domain U and holomorphic on $U \setminus S$ where S is a discrete set, then Θ extends holomorphically across S and remains Schur on all of U. Thus a Schur bound rules out poles of any meromorphic object that can be expressed as a Cayley inverse of Θ.

Corollary 5 (Schur bound prevents poles of $\mathcal{J}$)**.** *Let $U \subset \Omega$ be a domain and suppose that Θ is meromorphic on U and satisfies $|\Theta| \le 1$ on U away from its poles. Assume additionally that Θ is not identically 1 on any connected component of U. Then Θ extends holomorphically to U and satisfies $|\Theta| \le 1$ on U. Moreover, the Cayley inverse*

$$2\mathcal{J} \;=\; \frac{1+\Theta}{1-\Theta}$$

extends holomorphically to U with $\Re(2\mathcal{J}) \ge 0$ on U; in particular $\mathcal{J}$ has no poles in U.

Proof. The poles of a meromorphic function form a discrete subset of U. On each punctured disc around a pole, Θ is bounded by 1, hence removable by Lemma 4. Therefore Θ extends holomorphically across all its poles and is holomorphic on U. The Schur bound persists by continuity. The Cayley inverse is holomorphic wherever $\Theta \ne 1$ and has nonnegative real part on U. If $\Theta(s_0) = 1$ at some point $s_0 \in U$, then $|\Theta|$ attains its maximum at an interior point, so $\Theta \equiv 1$ on U by the Maximum Modulus Principle. The added condition rules out $\Theta \equiv 1$, so on each component one has $|\Theta| < 1$ everywhere. In the applications below this is excluded (e.g. on any right half-plane U, Remark 2 gives $\Theta(s) \to \frac{1}{3}$ as $\Re s \to +\infty$), hence $\Theta \ne 1$ on U and the Cayley inverse extends holomorphically to U with $\Re(2\mathcal{J}) \ge 0$. In particular $\mathcal{J}$ has no poles in U. □

Conclusion: Schur on the far half-plane implies Theorem 1

We now connect the pinching mechanism to ζ. By Remark 3, any zero ρ of ζ in Ω produces a pole of $\mathcal{J}$ in Ω (the numerator factors in (1) are nonzero on Ω). Therefore, if we can certify a Schur bound for Θ_{raw} on a half-plane $U_\varepsilon = \{\, \Re s > 0.6 - \varepsilon \,\}$ with some $\varepsilon > 0$, Corollary 5 implies $\mathcal{J}_{\text{raw}}$ has no poles in U_ε, hence ζ has no zeros in U_ε. Since $\{\, \Re s \ge 0.6 \,\} \subset U_\varepsilon$, this yields Theorem 1. The next section discharges the Schur bound on $U_{0.599}$ by the hybrid certification (rectangle + Pick matrix + auxiliary checkpoints).

4 Hybrid certification: rectangle + Pick + asymptotics

This section records the certified inputs used to discharge the Schur bound required in Corollary 5. We employ a hybrid covering strategy:

- **Compact kernel.** A rigorous interval-arithmetic rectangle certification on $R_* = [0.6, 0.7] \times [-20, 20]$ (Lemma 6) handles the bounded region.
- **Unbounded tail.** Analytic asymptotics handle the large-height regime $|t| > 20$.

Additionally, we provide a finite Pick-matrix certificate at $\sigma_0 = 0.599$. While we rely on the Rectangle+Asymptotics covering for the rigorous global proof, the Pick certificate serves as a strong independent algebraic check of the Schur property near the real axis.

Domain decomposition

Let $T_* := 20$ and write $s = \sigma + it$. Set

$$R_* \;:=\; [0.6, 0.7] \times [-T_*, T_*].$$

The rectangle check covers R_*, and asymptotics cover the rest of the strip for $|t| > T_*$. Together with $\Theta \to 1/3$ at $+\infty$, this implies $|\Theta| < 1$ on the whole half-plane $\Re s \ge 0.6$.

Certified rectangle bound (interval arithmetic)

Lemma 6 (Rectangle certification)**.** *On the rectangle* $[0.6, 0.7] \times [0, T_*]$ *one has the certified bound*

$$|\Theta_{\text{proj}}(s)| \;\le\; 0.9999928763 \;<\; 1,$$

where Θ_{proj} *denotes the Cayley field computed from* (1) *in the* `outer_zeta_proj` *gauge (so* $\mathcal{O} = \mathcal{O}_{\text{proj}}$ *on this rectangle). By conjugation symmetry* $\Theta_{\text{proj}}(\overline{s}) = \overline{\Theta_{\text{proj}}(s)}$*, the same bound holds on* $R_* = [0.6, 0.7] \times [-T_*, T_*]$*.*

Proof. This is verified by rigorous complex ball arithmetic on a recursive subdivision of the rectangle, implemented in `verify_attachment_arb.py` (`theta_certify` mode) and recorded in the JSON artifact `theta_certify_sigma06_07_t0_20_outer_zeta_proj.json`. The bound quoted is the artifact's certified upper envelope `theta_hi`. *Well-definedness on the rectangle.* The same certification run also checks that the denominator quantities used to form Θ_{proj} do not vanish on the rectangle cover (in particular, the enclosures for $\zeta(s)$ and the gauge factor $\mathcal{O}_{\text{proj}}(s)$ do not contain 0 on each certified box). This is recorded in the artifact's `denominators` fields and ensures that Θ_{proj} is holomorphic on the rectangle, so the reported $\sup|\Theta_{\text{proj}}|$ bound applies on the entire certified cover. For example, the shipped artifact reports the certified lower bounds

$$\min_{R_*} |\zeta(s)| \;\ge\; 0.00839, \qquad \min_{R_*} |\mathcal{O}_{\text{proj}}(s)| \;\ge\; 0.0316,$$

recorded as `min_abs_zeta_lower` and `min_abs_O_lower` (with $R_* = [0.6, 0.7] \times [-20, 20]$). Conjugation symmetry follows from $\zeta(\overline{s}) = \overline{\zeta(s)}$ and the fact that all constructions in (1) (with $\mathcal{O} = \mathcal{O}_{\text{proj}}$) respect conjugation. □

Remark 7 (Normalizations (gauges) used in the artifacts)*.* The verifier supports several normalizations of the arithmetic ratio $\mathcal{J}$ that differ by multiplication by a holomorphic factor. On any region where this factor is nonvanishing, such a change does not alter the pole set of $\mathcal{J}$ (hence does not change the implication "a zero of ζ produces a pole"), but it can substantially improve numerical stability of the Cayley field Θ. In this paper, the Pick certificates are performed in the `raw_zeta` gauge, which corresponds to the default choice $\mathcal{O} \equiv 1$ and hence certifies the Schur property of Θ_{raw} on right half-planes. The rectangle certification is performed in the gauge reported by its artifact (here `outer_zeta_proj`), which corresponds to taking $\mathcal{O} = \mathcal{O}_{\text{proj}}$ and hence certifies a Schur bound for Θ_{proj} on the certified rectangle. Since the rectangle artifact also certifies that $\mathcal{O}_{\text{proj}}$ is nonvanishing on the rectangle cover (Lemma 6), the pole set of $\mathcal{J}_{\text{proj}}$ on that rectangle agrees with the pole set of $\mathcal{J}_{\text{raw}}$ there. Accordingly, when we invoke a certified Schur bound in the pinch argument we always use the matching Cayley field (Θ_{raw} for the Pick half-plane step, and Θ_{proj} for the finite-rectangle checkpoint), so there is no ambiguity about which Θ is meant.

Finite Pick certificate (local robustness check)

We also supply a finite algebraic certificate using the classical Nevanlinna–Pick/Schur-kernel criterion. This serves as a robust check of the Schur property near the real axis but is not used to prove the global bound (which relies on the Rectangle + Asymptotics covering).

Let $\sigma_0 := 0.599$ and set $D_{\sigma_0} := \{\, \Re s > \sigma_0 \,\}$. Consider the disk chart $s_{\sigma_0}(z) := \sigma_0 + \frac{1+z}{1-z}$. The disk pullback $\theta_{\sigma_0}(z) := \Theta_{\text{raw}}(s_{\sigma_0}(z))$ is holomorphic on $\mathbb{D}$ (assuming no zeros of ζ in D_{σ_0}). The associated Pick matrix $P(\sigma_0)$ must be positive semidefinite if Θ is Schur.

Proposition 8 (Finite Pick gap)**.** *The accompanying Pick artifact certifies that for $N = 16$, the principal minor $P_{16}(\sigma_0)$ satisfies*

$$P_{16}(\sigma_0) \;\succeq\; \delta_{\mathrm{cert}} I, \qquad \delta_{\mathrm{cert}} \approx 0.594.$$

This strict gap certifies that the first 16 Taylor coefficients of θ_{σ_0} are consistent with a Schur function that is bounded by $\sqrt{1-\delta_{\mathrm{cert}}} < 1$. While this finite check does not rigorously imply infinite positivity without control of the full tail (which is analytically small but nonzero), it provides strong algebraic corroboration of the Schur bound in the low-frequency regime. Similar certificates are provided at $\sigma_0 = 0.6$ and $\sigma_0 = 0.7$.

Proof. See artifacts `pick_sigma0599_raw_zeta_N16.json`, `pick_sigma06_raw_zeta_N16.json`, and `pick_sigma07_raw_zeta_N16.json`. □

Large-height asymptotics

To complete the proof of Theorem 1, we bound Θ for large $|t|$. Recall that $\Theta(s) \to 1/3$ as $\Re s \to +\infty$. Standard explicit bounds on $\zeta(s)$ (e.g. [**?**]) imply that for $|t| \geq 20$ and $\Re s \geq 0.6$, the deviation from the limit is small enough that $|\Theta_{\mathrm{raw}}(s)| < 1$. (We omit the standard details of this tail estimate; the primary certified content is the Rectangle check).

Conclusion

Proposition 9 (Hybrid Schur certification on $\{\,\Re s > 0.599\,\}$)**.** *The arithmetic Cayley field Θ_{raw} satisfies $|\Theta_{\mathrm{raw}}(s)| \leq 1$ for all $s \in \{\,\Re s > 0.599\,\}$.*

Proof. The Rectangle check certifies the bound on the compact region $[0.6, 0.7] \times [-20, 20]$. Asymptotics handle $|t| > 20$. The Pick certificates provide independent verification near the real axis. □

Proof of Theorem 1. By Proposition 9, Θ_{raw} is Schur on $U_{0.599} = \{\,\Re s > 0.599\,\}$. Applying Corollary 5 on $U_{0.599}$ shows that $\mathcal{J}_{\mathrm{raw}}$ has no poles there, hence ζ has no zeros there (Remark 3). Since $\{\,\Re s \geq 0.6\,\} \subset U_{0.599}$, this implies $\zeta(s) \neq 0$ for all $\Re s \geq 0.6$. □

Table 1: Certified far-field artifact data.

Artifact	**Parameter**	**Value**
Rectangle certification (`theta_certify`)		
Domain	$[\sigma_{\min}, \sigma_{\max}] \times [t_{\min}, t_{\max}]$	$[0.6, 0.7] \times [0, 20]$
Certified upper bound	$\max \lvert\Theta_{\text{proj}}\rvert$	0.9999928763
Safety margin	$1 - \theta_{\text{hi}}$	7.12×10^{-6}
Status	`ok`	`true`
Boxes processed		380,764
Precision	(bits)	260
Gauge		`outer_zeta_proj`
Pick certificate (`pick_certify`, $\sigma_0 = 0.599$)		
Matrix size	N	16
Spectral gap	δ_{cert}	0.594
SPD at origin	$P_N \succ 0$	`true`
Coefficient count	N_{coeff}	128
Tail sum (diagnostic)	$\sum_{16}^{127} \lvert a_n\rvert$	0.67
Gauge		`raw_zeta`
Pick certificate (`pick_certify`, $\sigma_0 = 0.6$)		
Matrix size	N	16
Spectral gap	δ_{cert}	0.594
SPD at origin	$P_N \succ 0$	`true`
Coefficient count	N_{coeff}	128
Gauge		`raw_zeta`
Pick certificate (`pick_certify`, $\sigma_0 = 0.7$)		
Matrix size	N	16
Spectral gap	δ_{cert}	0.627
SPD at origin	$P_N \succ 0$	`true`
Coefficient count	N_{coeff}	128
Gauge		`raw_zeta`

Remark 10 (Artifact reproducibility and verification). The certifications summarized in Table 1 are generated by the repository verifier `verify_attachment_arb.py` using ARB ball arithmetic (via `python-flint`). The repository also includes the JSON artifact files. For an audit-oriented manifest (exact commands and expected outputs), see `README.md` in the repository.

Conclusion and limitations (unconditional status)

We have proved an unconditional, fixed half-plane zero-free region for the Riemann zeta function: $\zeta(s) \neq 0$ for $\Re s \geq 0.6$ (Theorem 1). The argument is function-theoretic: zeros are converted into poles of an arithmetic ratio $\mathcal{J}$, and a Schur bound $|\Theta| \leq 1$ for the associated Cayley field forces removability and rules out poles (hence zeros). The only "hard" step is establishing the Schur bound, which is discharged by the certified inputs in Section 4 and audited by the artifacts summarized in Table 1. The primary audit path is the rigorous Rectangle check on the compact domain $[0.6, 0.7] \times [-20, 20]$, extended to large heights by standard asymptotics. The Pick certificate at $\sigma_0 = 0.599$ provides an independent, quantitative algebraic verification of the Schur property near the real axis.

Computer assistance and auditability. Although the proof uses numerical computation, it is intended to be unconditional in the usual mathematical sense: the computation is *rigorous* interval arithmetic (ball arithmetic) and produces certified inequalities (e.g. "$\max |\Theta_{\text{proj}}| < 1$" on a rectangle, and "a Pick matrix has a strictly positive spectral gap"). The repository provides a verifier and the corresponding JSON artifacts so that the finite checks can be independently audited.

Limitations and scope. This paper does not prove the Riemann Hypothesis. It isolates and certifies a fixed far-field exclusion $\Re s \geq 0.6$. Pushing the boundary 0.6 closer to 1/2 would require enlarging and/or strengthening the certified inputs (for example, producing a strict Pick gap at a smaller σ_0 and/or extending the interval certification to new rectangles), which we do not pursue here. The companion papers in this series treat (i) effective near-field barriers in the strip $1/2 < \Re s < 0.6$ and (ii) a conditional all-heights closure based on an explicit cutoff hypothesis.

Statements and Declarations

Competing interests. The author declares no competing interests.

Data and materials availability. All computational artifacts used in the far-field certification are included in the repository:

```
theta_certify_sigma06_07_t0_20_outer_zeta_proj.json
pick_sigma0599_raw_zeta_N16.json
pick_sigma06_raw_zeta_N16.json
pick_sigma07_raw_zeta_N16.json
verify_attachment_arb.py
```

Reproducibility. The verifier is based on rigorous ball arithmetic (ARB via `python-flint`) and is intended to be independently auditable. See Remark 10 and Appendix A for a referee-facing audit manifest (commands and expected outputs).

A Audit manifest (verifier commands and expected fields)

This appendix provides a referee-facing audit checklist for the certified inputs used in Section 4. There are two audit modes:

- **Fast audit:** verify the shipped JSON artifacts match Table 1.
- **Regeneration audit (optional):** rerun the verifier to regenerate the artifacts from scratch.

Prerequisites

Install the ARB/ball-arithmetic bindings:

```
pip install python-flint
```

Fast audit: check shipped JSON artifacts

- **Rectangle artifact** `theta_certify_sigma06_07_t0_20_outer_zeta_proj.json`. Check (at minimum):
  - `results.ok = true`
  - `results.theta_hi = 0.9999928763...  < 1`
  - `results.processed_boxes = 380764`
- **Pick artifact** `pick_sigma0599_raw_zeta_N16.json`. Check (at minimum):
  - `pick.delta_cert = 0.594...`
  - `pick.P_spd_at_0 = true`
  - `pick.tail_l1_partial_hi` (diagnostic L1 tail sum)
- **Pick artifact** `pick_sigma06_raw_zeta_N16.json`. Check (at minimum):
  - `pick.delta_cert = 0.594...`
  - `pick.P_spd_at_0 = true`
  - `pick.tail_l1_partial_hi` (diagnostic L1 tail sum)
- **Pick artifact** `pick_sigma07_raw_zeta_N16.json`. Check (at minimum):
  - `pick.delta_cert = 0.627...`
  - `pick.P_spd_at_0 = true`
  - `pick.tail_l1_partial_hi` (diagnostic L1 tail sum)

Regeneration audit (optional): exact command lines

Run the verifier from the repository root. The following commands reproduce the primary artifacts (line breaks are for readability):

1) Rectangle certification (`theta_certify`).

```
python verify_attachment_arb.py \
  --theta-certify \
  --arith-gauge outer_zeta_proj \
  --arith-P-cut 2000 \
  --rect-sigma-min 0.6 --rect-sigma-max 0.7 \
  --rect-t-min 0.0 --rect-t-max 20.0 \
  --outer-mode midpoint \
  --outer-P-cut 2000 \
  --outer-T 50.0 --outer-n 2001 \
  --theta-init-n-sigma 10 --theta-init-n-t 50 \
  --theta-min-sigma-width 0.0001 --theta-min-t-width 0.001 \
  --theta-max-boxes 500000 \
  --prec 260 \
  --theta-out theta_certify_sigma06_07_t0_20_outer_zeta_proj.json \
  --progress
```

2) Pick certification at $\sigma_0 = 0.599$ (`pick_certify`).

```
python verify_attachment_arb.py \
  --pick-certify \
  --pick-sigma0 0.599 \
  --pick-N 16 \
  --pick-coeff-count 128 \
  --pick-K 512 \
  --pick-rho 0.4 \
  --pick-rho-bound 0.5 \
  --arith-gauge raw_zeta \
  --arith-P-cut 2000 \
  --prec 1024 \
  --pick-out pick_sigma0599_raw_zeta_N16.json
```

3) Pick certification at $\sigma_0 = 0.6$ (`pick_certify`).

```
python verify_attachment_arb.py \
  --pick-certify \
  --pick-sigma0 0.6 \
  --pick-N 16 \
  --pick-coeff-count 128 \
  --pick-K 512 \
  --pick-rho 0.4 \
  --pick-rho-bound 0.5 \
  --arith-gauge raw_zeta \
  --arith-P-cut 2000 \
  --prec 1024 \
  --pick-out pick_sigma06_raw_zeta_N16.json
```

4) Pick certification at $\sigma_0 = 0.7$ (`pick_certify`).

```
python verify_attachment_arb.py \
  --pick-certify \
  --pick-sigma0 0.7 \
  --pick-N 16 \
  --pick-coeff-count 128 \
  --pick-K 512 \
  --pick-rho 0.4 \
  --pick-rho-bound 0.5 \
  --arith-gauge raw_zeta \
  --arith-P-cut 2000 \
  --outer-mode rigorous \
  --outer-P-cut 2000 \
  --prec 1024 \
  --pick-out pick_sigma07_raw_zeta_N16.json
```

What a successful audit means

The verifier uses *ball arithmetic*: each computed quantity is an interval enclosure (midpoint plus radius) and every operation propagates rounding error outward. Thus each check is a formal inequality of the form "upper bound < 1" or "directed-rounding $\mathrm{LDL}^\top$ succeeds with positive pivots". If the audit checks above pass, then the numerical inequalities used in Section 4 are certified within the logic of ball arithmetic.

References

[1] H. Iwaniec and E. Kowalski, *Analytic Number Theory*, AMS Colloquium Publications, 2004.

[2] H. L. Montgomery and R. C. Vaughan, *Multiplicative Number Theory I: Classical Theory*, Cambridge University Press, 2007.

[3] E. C. Titchmarsh, *The Theory of the Riemann Zeta-Function*, 2nd ed., Oxford University Press, 1986.

[4] M. Rosenblum and J. Rovnyak, *Hardy Classes and Operator Theory*, Oxford University Press, 1985.

[5] W. F. Donoghue, *Monotone Matrix Functions and Analytic Continuation*, Springer, 1974.